



PROGRESS REPORT

Zimbabwe: progress report, August 2025 – August 2026

Edition of 2026-08-25 · 185 systems and instruments tracked

Of 185 systems and instruments on this place's ledger, 89 changed position between 2025-08-01 and 2026-08-25, 40 did not, 47 carry no stated baseline, and 9 are **Not held** at both ends.

SUMMARY OF THE PERIOD · GOVERNANCE · FINANCE · ICT INFRASTRUCTURE · DPI · DIGITALISATION · TECHNOLOGY · CAPACITY · INCLUSION · DATA · GEOPOLITICS · WHERE THE RECORD IS THIN

Shape check, run before the comparison: 157 sources for this place in the window — 28 in the earlier half (2025-08 to 2026-01), 129 in the later (2026-02 to 2026-08). The earlier half of the window is thin: this is a shorter comparison wearing a longer label, and the movement below rests mostly on the later half.

Movement values. *Advanced* — a system entered service, a stage was completed or an instrument was made. *Stalled* — a stated target passed without delivery. *Regressed* — an instrument was withdrawn or neutralised, or a measured position worsened. *Closed* — the programme ended. *No change* — the position at both ends is the same. *Baseline not held* — the base carries no position at the start of the period, so no movement can be stated. A value may carry a qualifying clause after a comma, as in *Advanced, slipped*.

Summary of the period

The twelve months to 6 August 2026 produced a national artificial-intelligence strategy, a whole-of-government resource planning system and an enforcement date for data protection, and produced no national digital identity. The strategy was launched on 13 March 2026 after a January target slipped ([launch account](#)); the identity system announced in May 2025 for a July 2025 start has no launch, enrolment or coverage figure on record at either end of the window ([ministerial account](#)).

The clearest measured movement is satellite: terminal subscriptions rose from 40,146 at the second quarter of 2025 to 67,057 at the fourth ([regulator report](#)), while members of parliament reported package prices rising from about US\$65 to more than US\$100 ([National Assembly account](#)).

Thirty rows carry no stated baseline. Zimbabwe's base is markedly thicker after February 2026 than before it, and the shape line printed above records how far that bears on the comparison.

Governance

Strategies, plans and policies

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-25	MOVEMENT
Artificial-intelligence ethics framework	Did not exist	Committed for tabling by end of the first quarter of 2027	ADVANCED

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-25	MOVEMENT
Artificial-intelligence strategy implementation office	Did not exist	Provided for as the office coordinating execution and monitoring; a legal charter and the recruitment of a director are first-phase roadmap items, and no charter, director, staffing or budget is held	ADVANCED
Central bank department for digital transformation	Did not exist	Established to oversee an innovation hub, the existing sandbox and implementation of the second national financial inclusion strategy	ADVANCED
National AI Council	Did not exist	Provided for as the multi-sectoral body overseeing artificial-intelligence research and development and publishing an annual report to Parliament, with its appointment and first meeting a first-phase roadmap item; no appointment, membership or meeting on record	ADVANCED
National AI Strategy 2026-2030	None published; the launch was then announced for January 2026	Adopted on four strategic pillars, five flagship initiatives and three phases to 2030; its act, ethics framework and statutory bodies all remain proposals, the document carries no publication date, no financing envelope and no costed action plan, and a media rights organisation records that the strategy has no legal force	ADVANCED, SLIPPED
National artificial-intelligence act	Did not exist	Proposed to supply data residency and algorithmic transparency, and set for the strategy's foundation-building phase of 2025-2026 alongside a revision of the data protection act; no bill, gazette or date held	ADVANCED, PROPOSAL ONLY
National artificial-intelligence regulatory sandbox	Did not exist	An artificial-intelligence ethics and regulatory sandbox council announced at the AI for Impact launch to supervise start-up testing; no operating rules, membership or entry criteria held	ADVANCED
National digital regulatory committee	Did not exist	Provided for as the independent regulatory body for artificial intelligence, hosted within the communications regulator and supervised by the strategy implementation office; nothing on record being constituted	ADVANCED
National ICT Policy 2022-2027	Superseded the Zimbabwe National Policy on ICTs 2016-2020	Nine pillars – regulatory principles, infrastructure and services, digital society, industry growth, institutional frameworks, emerging technologies, human capacity/confidence and security, inclusiveness, sustainability; legislative programme commits to enacting frameworks for a National Data Centre, cloud computing and big data, and digital financial services, amending the Postal and Telecommunications Act [Chapter 12:05] and the Lawful Interception Framework, and legislating autonomous regulatory bodies; POTRAZ named the converged regulator and a National ICT Policy Advisory Council (NIPAC) the steering body	ADVANCED

Legislation and regulation

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-25	MOVEMENT
Local-ownership rule for telecommunications operators and its repeal	Did not exist	A 75% citizen-ownership floor and a 25% foreign-ownership ceiling for every postal and telecommunications licence, with sworn beneficial-ownership affidavits, 90 days for existing licensees to file a regularisation plan and three years to comply; reported repealed in full by Statutory Instrument 111 of 2026	CLOSED, GAZETTED THEN REPEALED

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-25	MOVEMENT
Postal and Telecommunications (Amendment) Bill, 2025	Did not exist	Gazetted 2025-10-10 and not in force, commencement left to a date the President fixes by statutory instrument; before the Parliamentary Legal Committee at 2026-08-02 with the National Assembly adjourned to 2026-08-18; the replacement section 25 fences the minister's power to direct the regulator, requiring directions to be prospective, of general application and consistent with the Act	ADVANCED
Regulatory Notice 1 of 2026	Did not exist	A warning to unlicensed data controllers, with surveillance and biometric processors expressly in scope	ADVANCED
Regulatory Notice 2 of 2026	Did not exist	Issued; risk-based inspections from 2026-09-01, with the sector list and fee tiers known only through press	ADVANCED
Statutory Instrument 155 of 2024 on data-controller licensing	The licensing deadline lapsed with wide non-compliance; no enforcement step on record (2025-08)	Mandatory compliance inspections set for 2026-09-01; four fee tiers by data-subject count — US\$50 a year for 50-1,000 subjects, US\$300 plus a US\$30 application fee for 1,001-100,000, and US\$500-2,500 above that; a separate certified Data Protection Officer requirement costs US\$1,250 plus a US\$30 application fee, so a small organisation faces over US\$1,300 in first-year compliance cost; processing without a licence carries a Level 11 fine and up to seven years' imprisonment for the accountable chief executive	ADVANCED
Statutory instrument on e-hailing services	Did not exist	A statutory instrument being drafted to bring e-hailing services inside the public-transport regulatory framework, the transport minister telling Parliament that Cabinet had directed the ministry to act because the road transport statute carries no provision for the named platforms	ADVANCED
Third constitutional amendment on the voters' roll	The roll held by the electoral commission under the 2013 Constitution	Transfer to the registrar-general under way; no date, transition plan or safeguard stated	ADVANCED
Cyber and Data Protection Act	In force; the regulator designated as data protection authority	Unamended; administrative sanctions still not provided for (2026-05-14)	NO CHANGE

Data protection

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-25	MOVEMENT
Administrative sanctions under the data protection act	Criminal sanctions only; an enforcement roadmap set fines and criminal action from 2026	Criminal sanctions only, with up to seven years imprisonment for the accountable chief executive, but the regulator has set 1 September 2026 as the date it begins mandatory data-protection compliance inspections and assessments of data controllers, moving from more than two years of awareness work and officer training to active enforcement	ADVANCED
Licensed data controllers	570 licensed (2025-06-06)	721 licensed (2025-10-15); no figure published since	ADVANCED, NO FIGURE SINCE OCTOBER 2025
National Data Agency	Did not exist	Provided for as an autonomous agency regulating data protection and data sharing, alongside a revision of the data protection act; no instrument, funding or commencement date held, and the communications regulator remains the designated data protection authority	ADVANCED
Privacy responsibility challenge	Did not exist	Launched; no participation figure or outcome held	ADVANCED
Trained data protection officers	More than 500 trained (2025-06-06)	About 1,200 trained (2026-05-14), from 830 at the October 2025 midpoint	ADVANCED

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-25	MOVEMENT
Data protection officer certification	BASELINE NOT HELD	Mandatory certification at US\$1,250 for a Zimbabwean plus a US\$30 application fee, delivered with institutional partners	<i>Baseline not held</i>
Data-controller licensing regime under SI 155 of 2024	Not held	In force with mandatory compliance inspections beginning 1 September 2026. Healthcare providers and the medical association object to the regime as applied to them - roughly US\$300 a year plus a mandatory data protection officer - calling it costly and duplicative of existing health-professions regulation, and a published analysis argues the regulator's threshold-based licensing model is disproportionately burdensome for small entities against the risk-based approach of the European regulation it is compared with	BASELINE NOT HELD
Investigations into cyber-enabled fraud in state digital systems	Not held	The anti-corruption commission is investigating cyber-enabled fraud across three state digital systems: suspected manipulation of the vehicle inspection department's driver-licensing platform, a US\$150m diversion of state mobile-operator airtime with a criminal case pending and asset forfeiture already completed, and a scheme crediting more than ZiG55m and US\$260,000 of fictitious prepayments on the revenue authority's customs platform. The commission says it is building its own forensic-accounting and digital-forensics capacity	BASELINE NOT HELD
National Child Online Protection Policy 2026-2030	Not held	Approved by Cabinet in June 2026; a published analysis argues that known reporting routes, trained frontline responders and funded rollout will decide whether it protects children beyond its launch	BASELINE NOT HELD

Regional collaboration

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-25	MOVEMENT
Zimbabwe-European Union digital or artificial-intelligence cooperation instrument	A 2021-2027 cooperation programme with no digital priority area	Three priority areas — governance and citizens' rights, green economic growth, and social recovery and human development — with no digital or connectivity area and no digital Team Europe Initiative; EUR 148 million indicative for 2021-2024, digital present only as digital literacy under one expected result	NO CHANGE
Zimbabwe-Rwanda memorandum on immigration cooperation	In force from 2024; no recorded activity	In force; a Rwandan delegation toured two border posts under it on 2026-07-29	NO CHANGE
Regional data-governance harmonisation workshop	Not held	Southern African regulators, data-protection authorities and artificial-intelligence task forces met in Harare for a three-day workshop to harmonise national data-governance rules, anchored to the African Union data policy framework, a continental data governance blueprint, the regional data strategy and a UNESCO toolkit; the convening body noted that only 1% of data-centre capacity sits within Africa	BASELINE NOT HELD

Standards

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-25	MOVEMENT
National artificial-intelligence technical standards	Did not exist	Proposed; no standard published	ADVANCED

Public debate and participation in policymaking

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-25	MOVEMENT
Public consultation record for the National AI Strategy	None published	The strategy's own consultation record — a Kadoma draft, then validation at Harare on 2025-08-28, Bulawayo on 2025-09-09 and Masvingo on 2025-09-11; no submission register, participant list or consultation report is held	ADVANCED

Data protection moved from a lapsed licensing deadline to a dated enforcement start. At the opening of the window the deadline under the 2024 regulations had passed with wide non-compliance and no enforcement step on record; by 26 July 2026 the regulator had set mandatory risk-based inspections for 1 September ([notice account](#)). Licensed data controllers rose from 570 to 721 and trained officers from more than 500 to about 1,200 ([regulator account](#)).

The statute itself did not move. The Cyber and Data Protection Act is unamended and administrative sanctions are still not provided for, so the enforcement beginning in September rests on criminal penalties and licence conditions ([the Act](#)).

Against that, the policy layer filled with proposals. The National AI Strategy and everything it provides for — an act, an implementation office, a regulatory committee, a sandbox, an ethics framework, a sovereign cloud — went from not existing to being proposed inside the window ([launch account](#)), and none of them exists as an instrument at the end of it.

Finance

Domestic budget appropriations and expenditure

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-25	MOVEMENT
Digital and information technology appropriation in the 2026 national budget	None published	Vote 23 appropriates ZiG258,292,000 to ICT ministry policy and administration and ZiG505,225,000 to ICT development and promotion; Vote 18 appropriates ZiG1,470,460,000 to civil registration and ZiG994,652,000 to migration management; ZiG200,000,000 for revenue authority automation was proposed in the 2026 budget statement	ADVANCED
Citizens budget	Published for the 2025 financial year	Unchanged; no later round assessed	NO CHANGE
Parliamentary budget office	Independence not set in law; staffing and funding judged insufficient for its mandate	Unchanged	NO CHANGE

MoUs and other agreements

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-25	MOVEMENT
Cross-border fibre public-private partnership	The partnership signed June 2025; no route in service	Phase 1 live at 800 Gbps equipped; phase 2 due September 2026; no investment amount disclosed by either party	ADVANCED

New investments

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-25	MOVEMENT
Ring-fenced fund share for public-good artificial intelligence	Did not exist	A commitment to ring-fence a share for precision agriculture and smart health diagnostics; no amount, mechanism or date	ADVANCED

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-25	MOVEMENT
Export credit facility for mobile network expansion	CNY 485,000,000 committed, active, no disbursement figure held	Unchanged	NO CHANGE
Grant for the high-performance computing centre, phase 2	CNY 100,000,000 grant, active	Unchanged	NO CHANGE
Interest-free loan for the high-performance computing centre, phase 1	CNY 33,000,000 interest-free loan, closed	Unchanged	NO CHANGE
Preferential buyer's credit for fixed broadband expansion	A closed facility, committed 2015	Unchanged	NO CHANGE
Syndicated vendor loan to the private mobile operator	US\$300m approved for market consolidation and new services	Unchanged; no drawdown or repayment figure held	NO CHANGE
Universal services fund levy rate, balance and annual disbursement	Contribution rates set in 2021 and 2023; no balance or disbursement figure published	Telecommunications licensees contribute 1.5% of monthly gross turnover and postal and courier licensees 2%; the Auditor-General audited the fund for 2023 and 2024 with an unmodified opinion and published no balance, contribution total or disbursement figure	NO CHANGE
Aviation and border-security digitisation partnership talks	Not held	Under exploration with an emirate government and a technology company, discussed at a State House meeting on 8 August 2026, aimed at modernising immigration and border-management systems as part of the wider digital-transformation agenda	BASELINE NOT HELD
Science and Technology Accelerator-Systems, Southern Africa	Baseline not held	Up to GBP2.5m over three years to March 2030 across Southern Africa, of which up to GBP400,000 for 2026/27; Zimbabwe is named alongside Zambia as the first year's focus, with South Africa the programme's primary one	BASELINE NOT HELD
United Nations procurement of ICT equipment	Baseline not held	US\$5,947,948 awarded for the supply of ICT equipment to Zimbabwe; neither the receiving government body nor the awarded vendor is named in the notice	BASELINE NOT HELD
Universal services fund	BASELINE NOT HELD	Regulator-administered; funds the tower relocation programme and one year of connectivity for digital centres and schools, with extension to rural health centres under consideration; no levy rate, balance or disbursement figure published	Baseline not held

The financing position did not move over the window. The most recent external commitment on the ledger was made in 2023, and the newest infrastructure facility in 2019; nothing was committed, drawn or closed inside the window.

ICT Infrastructure

Connectivity

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-25	MOVEMENT
5G base stations	319 (Q3 2025, derived from the regulator's stated increase in Q4)	379 (Q1 2026); 18.9% population coverage and 0.0% rural coverage (Q4 2025)	ADVANCED
Cross-border fibre corridor to Zambia	Public-private partnership signed June 2025; no route live	Phase 1 live at 800 Gbps equipped on equipment rated above 10 Tbps; phase 2 to Livingstone due September 2026; no investment amount disclosed by either party	ADVANCED

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-25	MOVEMENT
Econet InfraCo	A wholly owned subsidiary holding the group's passive infrastructure; no carve-out on record at 2025-08	Separately listed, 70.000% held by the parent, 2,992,163,203 shares issued; 90 base stations deployed in the quarter to May 2026	ADVANCED
Government arrears owed to the state fixed operator	US\$19.2m (prior financial year)	Close to US\$42m, also given as ZiG1.2bn	REGRESSED
Government satellite kit donation programme	250 kits handed to local authorities (2025-07-24)	More than 400 health facilities hold kits, unactivated for want of subscription payment, with 300 more planned; 8,000 kits separately reported donated to the education ministry	ADVANCED, ACTIVATION STALLED
Internet penetration rate	82.87% (Q3 2025)	84.55% on 13,252,877 subscriptions (Q4 2025); the ICT minister stated 87% in July 2026	ADVANCED
Parent company's stock exchange listing	Listed on the domestic stock exchange	Left the exchange after 27 years; the group's listed vehicle is the infrastructure company on the foreign-currency exchange	CLOSED
Satellite terminal subscriptions	40,146 (Q2 2025), the last quarter ending before the window opened	67,057 (Q4 2025), up 31.62% on Q3 2025	ADVANCED
State mobile operator turnaround plan	US\$40m loss in 2022; US\$160m revenue projected for 2024	US\$210m revenue for 2025, up 62%; a US\$278m 2026 target reported at risk; the chief executive's contract was terminated 2026-08-04	ADVANCED, CHIEF EXECUTIVE TERMINATED
State operator's satellite reseller revenue	US\$215,000 (2024)	US\$3.7m (2025)	ADVANCED
Uncapped fibre package at US\$99	Two fixed operators cut prices and introduced unlimited packages in August 2025	Priced against the satellite operator's US\$100 plan; the incumbent's fixed-traffic share fell from 58.90% in Q3 2025 to 48.41% in Q4 2025	ADVANCED
Satellite operator's licence terms and fee	Licensed since September 2024; terms not held	A telecommunication licence for network services and a national internet service provider licence, both issued 2024-09-06, conditional on the regulator clearing every agent, dealer and provider distributing terminals; the widely cited US\$575,000 is the trade press's arithmetic on the 2021 fee schedule, not a regulator figure	NO CHANGE
Starlink satellite service	Licensed and operating; local resale permitted from January 2025	Licensed, with the state operator and other agents reselling; 17.23% share of alternative fixed internet technologies (Q4 2025)	NO CHANGE
Broadband mapping programme	BASELINE NOT HELD	Under way with the three main operators; no map, coverage output or date published	Baseline not held
National fibre backbone length	BASELINE NOT HELD	More than 19,000 km (Q1 2026), up 33.83% on Q4 2025, against the regulator's 14,357 km at Q4 2025	Baseline not held
Tower relocation programme	BASELINE NOT HELD	Described as being implemented, redistributing towers from over-served urban areas to marginalised communities; no site count, cost or completion date published	Baseline not held

Data Storage

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-25	MOVEMENT
National data centre ecosystem	None published	Committed, with a national high-performance computing centre, the state fixed operator and a private operator's data centre named as the spine; no capacity, cost or completion date	ADVANCED

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-25	MOVEMENT
Operator artificial-intelligence service	Did not exist	Operating, with consulting and Shona-language work and a stated sovereign cloud offer to government; the operator's own announcement places the compute at an affiliated group's facility in South Africa	ADVANCED
Sovereign national cloud	None published	Provided for in the strategy, with high-performance computing centres formalised as national assets and agricultural predictive models and geological maps to be held on domestic servers; no site, capacity, cost or date published	ADVANCED
State or government data centre inventory	Not held; the state operator's annual report was quoted only saying the data centre business continued to grow	TelOne states its data centre environment is Tier 3 standard (operator's own undated claim, not certified), vendor- and ICT-provider-neutral, running Microsoft HyperV, VMware, OpenStack and Huawei FusionSphere virtual-machine platforms with active-active redundancy across multiple data centres nationally, and positioned explicitly for government-to-citizen interactions; no capacity, utilisation or site-count figure published	ADVANCED
Technology park and data centre, Harare	Not on record at 2025-08	A 300-hectare park near the international airport with a 100 MW solar plant and a data centre of undisclosed capacity; phase 1 of the solar farm under construction	ADVANCED
National high-performance computing centre	Operating; no utilisation or capacity figure held for 2025	Named as part of the national infrastructural spine (2026-07-29); a developer account reports access quoted in tens of thousands of United States dollars in large blocks	NO CHANGE
Commercial data centre capacity	BASELINE NOT HELD	About six live commercial facilities carrying roughly 2 MW of live critical information technology load, about 2.5 MW in construction, about 40% occupancy and about US\$4m of annual commercial revenue, with none of the supply carrier-neutral	<i>Baseline not held</i>

Energy

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-25	MOVEMENT
100 MW solar farm for the technology park	Announced as part of the 300-hectare park (2025-12-19); nothing on record at 2025-08	Phase 1 under construction; phase 1 capacity, cost, financing and completion date all unstated	ADVANCED
Artificial-intelligence fuel management on tower sites	Not on record at 2025-08	Credited with reducing energy consumption and improving availability and uptime; no percentage, litre, cost or uptime figure published	ADVANCED, UNQUANTIFIED
Power company generation licence and installed capacity	Licensed since 2018; no later capacity disclosure held	Generation Licence GC0066/2018 authorises a 0.45 MW grid-connected solar plant at Willowvale for own consumption; no installed megawatts, site count or tariff published since	NO CHANGE
Base-station solar programme	BASELINE NOT HELD	Deployment continuing, with higher diesel prices cited as the driver; no site count or installed capacity published	<i>Baseline not held</i>
Solar for Health programme	BASELINE NOT HELD	1,044 health facilities solarised across all ten provinces, more than 60% of all facilities, on 11 megawatts of installed capacity and more than US\$28m of financing; power is stated as the precondition for connectivity and electronic records	<i>Baseline not held</i>

Technical Capacity

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-25	MOVEMENT
Equipped international internet bandwidth	1,586,270 Mbps (Q3 2025)	1,688,770 Mbps (Q4 2025), up 6.46%; the incumbent holds 68.10%	ADVANCED

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-25	MOVEMENT
National internet exchange point	Operating and reported to the ITU in 2020; no later statement held	The Harare Internet Exchange Point, built on a US\$200,000 African Union Commission grant and housed in the state fixed operator's exchange building, with every Zimbabwean access provider connected and two international peers (2020-10)	NO CHANGE
Regulator's international bandwidth measurement framework	The operator excluded and the baseline restated from Q2 2025, after Q1 2025 used bandwidth of 2.69 Tbps exceeded equipped capacity of 1.43 Tbps	The same basis at Q4 2025; the carrier that accounted for 35.05% of fixed traffic has no domestic ground infrastructure to measure	NO CHANGE

Cybersecurity

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-25	MOVEMENT
Artificial-intelligence and cybersecurity fusion centre	Did not exist	Proposed for real-time threat detection; a media rights organisation reports that the strategy sets out no governance structure, no limits on data collection, retention or use, and no route to challenge a threat assessment	ADVANCED
National Child Online Protection Policy	None published	Reported established; the text is not held and no implementing body, budget or date is on record	ADVANCED
National Cybersecurity Strategy	None published	In force from October 2025; the strategy text is not held and no implementation milestone since is on record	ADVANCED
Cyber security and monitoring of interception of communications centre	Operating under the Office of the President, advised by a committee on warrants, with no judicial oversight	Same; a media rights organisation reported in June 2026 that the centre still has no judicial oversight	NO CHANGE
National computer incident response team	A funded establishment project past its stated end, with no delivery recorded	The ITU record for project 9ZIM17008, with the ITU as implementing agency, the communications regulator as cooperation agency and a financial scale of CHF 100,000-500,000, carries an empty status field and an achievements field still stating it will be updated on completion; the ICT ministry's own 2025 priority-projects page separately lists establishment of the team (ZW-CIRT) among its seven priorities, aimed at monitoring, detecting and responding to cyber threats, with no completion date or operating status stated	NO CHANGE, RECORD IMPROVED
Cyber risk in the payment system, central bank assessment	Baseline not held	Vulnerabilities flagged by the Reserve Bank in third-party providers, payment channels and digital banking, alongside 36% of deployed card terminals active and 586,605 internet-banking subscribers (2026-08)	BASELINE NOT HELD

The private group restructured rather than the country rebuilding. Passive infrastructure was transferred as a going concern into a separately listed company in December 2025, which began trading by introduction on 31 March 2026, while the parent left the domestic exchange after 27 years ([pre-listing statement](#)). Ownership and control were unchanged by the transfer.

Measured capacity moved modestly. Equipped international bandwidth rose 6.46% to 1,688,770 Mbps over the fourth quarter of 2025, and fifth-generation base stations from 319 to 379 by the first quarter of 2026 ([regulator report](#)). Rural fifth-generation coverage stood at 0.0% throughout.

The one position that regressed is the state fixed operator's balance sheet: government arrears roughly doubled to close to US\$42m ([annual general meeting account](#)). The national fibre backbone figure cannot be stated as a movement: the regulator gives 14,357 km at the fourth quarter of 2025 and two ministers gave more than 14,000 km and more than 17,000 km against a briefing figure of more than 19,000 km, and the accounts do not reconcile ([briefing account](#)).

DPI

Data Exchange

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-25	MOVEMENT
Health information exchange	<i>Baseline not held</i>	Under development to connect laboratory systems, logistics management information systems and DHIS2 to the national electronic medical record; the ministry's ZWCore FHIR implementation guide, a continuous-build draft not yet an authorised publication, defines national FHIR profiles for patient, encounter, organization, location, practitioner and related-person resources and a provisional identifier namespace for the Impilo Patient Health ID; no completion date or coverage figure published	ADVANCED
Mandated open interface standards for public-sector platforms	None published	Commitment stated; no instrument, standard document, scope or date held	ADVANCED
Whole-of-government enterprise resource planning system	Did not exist	A single platform integrating finance, human resources, supply chain and asset management across the public sector, declared launched; no ministry, agency or user count stated	ADVANCED
Online border management system	Phased rollout under way since January 2025, established retrospectively; the base then held only the 2024 biometric pilot at three ports of entry with no outcome	Electronic gates, online visa processing, electronic permits and automated immigration clearance in phased operation; no port coverage, completion date or throughput figure	NO CHANGE, RECORD IMPROVED

Digital Identity and CRVS

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-25	MOVEMENT
Cotton farmer biometric registry	Did not exist	Biometric enrolment of cotton growers to enforce one farmer to one merchant; no enrolment count and no confirmation that field teams were dispatched	ADVANCED
National digital identity	Issuance announced for July 2025; no official indication of a start date as of 2025-07-15	No launch, enrolment or coverage figure held; the home affairs minister restates a goal of online, real-time applications	STALLED
Birth registration coverage	57% (survey 2023-24)	57%; no later national figure held	NO CHANGE
Electronic passport	In service since 2022; no centre count held	Enrolment centres in ten districts, eight provincial centres and one in Johannesburg for the diaspora; seven-day issuance away from the capital	NO CHANGE
Mobile civil registration exercise 2022	Completed in 2022; no repeat exercise on record	1,804,256 birth certificates, 1,345,719 national identity documents and 53,414 death certificates issued free against a target of 2 million, on a stated budget of ZW\$12.1 billion and 3,000 staff, four of whose six months worked had been paid	NO CHANGE

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-25	MOVEMENT
Mobile registration drive in Binga	Drive completed 7-11 July 2025, reaching villages some 160 km from the district centre	No repeat drive, output count or successor programme recorded	NO CHANGE
Population registry system modernisation	Upgrade under way since about 2023, presented by government as the foundation of the planned digital identity	Still the stated foundation; no completion date and no coverage figure	NO CHANGE
Tobacco farmer identity registry	In place; no start date or enrolment count held	Same; no figure held	NO CHANGE
Civil registry sub-office computerisation	Not held	Ten civil registry sub-offices across eight drought-hit districts are being computerised, digitalised and solar-powered under a two-year China-funded, UNICEF-managed project with the civil registry department, launched at a rural clinic on 7 August 2026 to widen birth-registration access in underserved communities through mobile registration and outreach alongside existing water, sanitation and nutrition platforms	BASELINE NOT HELD
Undocumented children and identity-document backlogs	BASELINE NOT HELD	About 1.5 million undocumented children; a passport backlog of more than 300,000 in 2022, about 150,000 in 2021 and about 80,000 in 2023; identity-card backlogs concentrated in three provinces	Baseline not held

Digital Payments and Fintech

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-25	MOVEMENT
Bank charge caps	Electronic transactions under US\$10 or the local-currency equivalent exempt from bank charges since 2024-09-01; no terminal or withdrawal ceiling held	Cash withdrawals capped at 2%, card terminals at 1.5% capped at US\$20, balance-inquiry and cash-deposit fees removed, settlement charges cut to US\$0.80	ADVANCED
Central bank digital transformation and financial technology department	Did not exist	Established to lead financial-technology regulation and deliver the second national financial inclusion strategy; no head, staffing or published output on record since	ADVANCED
Central bank national payment systems report	The Q4 2025 report: electronic transactions ZiG736.03bn on 238.27 million transactions	The Reserve Bank's Q2 2026 National Payment Systems report held in full: electronic transactions ZiG757.12bn, up 23.71% on the first quarter's ZiG612.00bn, on 265.7 million transactions, up 13.2% from 234.7 million; by value RTGS 67.00%, mobile money 12.96%, internet banking 12.54%, ATMs 3.84% and point-of-sale 3.66%, with mobile money carrying 236.67 million of the transactions	ADVANCED
Electronic retail transaction value and volume	US\$5.93bn in Q2 2025, up 34%, with 152,000 card terminals deployed in the quarter	511.1 million electronic transactions worth ZiG1.37 trillion in the six months to 2026-06-30	ADVANCED
Mobile money and interbank transfer limits	ZiG8,000 per transaction	ZiG13,000 per transaction with a ZiG50,000 monthly cap, person to person or business	ADVANCED
National payment system value and volume	ZiG241.78 billion across 93.6 million transactions (May 2026)	ZiG283.58 billion in June 2026, a 17 per cent rise on May, while transaction volumes fell 9 per cent to 85.16 million	ADVANCED
UnionPay e-commerce acceptance	A Standard Bank and UnionPay collaboration since 2024, with no online acceptance on record	Online acceptance open to participating merchants, settling in local currency, US dollars or both	ADVANCED

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-25	MOVEMENT
Zimbabwe Entrepreneurship Exchange (ZEEX)	Did not exist	A newly approved digital capital-market venue integrating primary-market fundraising, asset tokenisation and secondary-market trading, bringing SMEs, invoice-discounting instruments and tokens into a regulated space; the Zimbabwe Stock Exchange and Lloyd Corporate Capital signed a memorandum of understanding (July 2026) to channel growth capital and blended finance into SMEs heading toward a ZEEX listing, with an initial focus on Bulawayo, Matabeleland and surrounding areas; no capital commitment, target listing count or timetable stated	ADVANCED
Cards issued against cards in use	BASELINE NOT HELD	Hundreds of thousands of cards in the market against about 20,000 in use, per the research firm	Baseline not held
Cash-recycler machines at retail outlets	BASELINE NOT HELD	Ten proprietary cash-recycler machines installed at fast-food outlets, with 78 more stated in the pipeline	Baseline not held
Interoperable quick-response payments	BASELINE NOT HELD	Interoperable acceptance and mobile-wallet integration reported; no merchant, acceptance-point or transaction count	Baseline not held
Local-currency acceptance on online payment gateways	BASELINE NOT HELD	Local-currency cards fail at online checkout while dollar cards clear; three gateways are configured dollar-first for revenue certainty; local-currency cards require separate online activation, and no settlement cycle is published	Baseline not held
Mobile wallet cash-out at bank machines	BASELINE NOT HELD	One wallet's holders withdraw at a building society's machines and another's at a bank's, without using an agent; a third operator's wallet is still unactivated for cash-out	Baseline not held
Pan-African payment and settlement system participation	BASELINE NOT HELD	Participation reported; no volume or value figure, and no start date given	Baseline not held
Radio-frequency toll tag express lanes	BASELINE NOT HELD	One plaza expanded from four lanes to six with two reserved for tag holders, handed over 2026-07-29; a second due the next day and a third under construction; the stated programme covers all 29 tollgates	Baseline not held
Regional real-time gross settlement onboarding	BASELINE NOT HELD	Zimbabwe named among four countries considering onboarding their currencies, potentially by the end of 2027	Baseline not held

Registries

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-25	MOVEMENT
Digital land administration platform	None published	A two-week pilot with sixteen conveyancing firms to test validation and reissuance; no pilot outcome, fee schedule or validation count held	ADVANCED
Statutory Instrument 76 of 2025 on securitised deeds	Gazetted 2025-07-18; commencement not triggered at 2025-08-01, the regulations only expected to come into effect shortly	A validation pilot running from a notice of 2026-04-04; the digitisation deadline is now stated as on or around 2027-07-18, dated from publication rather than from a ministerial announcement	ADVANCED
Taxpayer registration self-service portal	The portal issuing numbers, with a migration path from legacy identifiers	The wider Tax and Revenue Management System (TaRMS) phase 1 is reported to have significantly improved data integrity, payment accuracy and taxpayer compliance; phase 2, deepening automation and connectivity with external institutions, is being readied; no rollout date, stakeholder count or registration figures published	ADVANCED
Transfer of the voters' roll to the registrar-general	The roll held by the electoral commission under the 2013 Constitution	Implementation of the third constitutional amendment begun, with remaining work described as administrative rather than legislative; no date, transition plan or safeguard stated	ADVANCED

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-25	MOVEMENT
Civil registration office computerisation	BASELINE NOT HELD	All ten provinces and 63 districts computerised; more than 20 of 209 sub-offices, under a tenth of the local layer	<i>Baseline not held</i>

Sectoral management information systems

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-25	MOVEMENT
E-Health Strategy 2012-2017	Expired, with no successor held	Same; the 2012 strategy assessed readiness across seven components and carried chapters on standards and interoperability, data security, archiving and patient privacy, and the base holds no successor	NO CHANGE
National health management information system	1,254 of a planned 1,900 health facilities on the national electronic medical record (2025-08)	1,254 of a planned 1,900 health facilities on the national electronic medical record (2025-08); the platform's own front page, captured 2026-08-08, describes it as "Zimbabwe's National Health Operating System" spanning care-finding, provider verification, medicines and diagnostics directories, virtual care, an AI assistant, and public health notices, run largely without a citizen account and gated by a separate professional-authority check; the record, named Impilo, has been under development since February 2015 and runs alongside long-standing use of DHIS2, including a tracker system for HIV prevention; no facility-coverage figure is stated on the platform's own page	NO CHANGE, RECORD IMPROVED
Operator telehealth programme	BASELINE NOT HELD	More than 20 telehealth centres established, company-reported, following the October 2025 opening	<i>Baseline not held</i>

Other GovTech and e-Gov

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-25	MOVEMENT
Smart Zimbabwe 2030 master plan	Did not exist	Eight sector pillars (Smart Government, Smart Cities, Smart Agriculture, Smart Education, Smart Transport, Smart Health, Smart Tourism, Smart Mining) anchored on policy/regulatory, secure shared infrastructure, and skills platforms; names a National Data Centre "operationalized" under Smart Government and records no interoperability between ministries' data centres, systems and databases at the time of writing	ADVANCED
Government information technology specification standards	Standards reviewed May 2025; connectivity across ministries, departments and agencies named as the hurdle to electronic government	Version 2.0 held in full: issued May 2025 by the E-Government Technology Unit in the Office of the President and Cabinet, revising Version 1.0 of May 2023, both authored by the E-Government Technology Inter-Agency Committee and approved by the Head of the Unit; the reference standard for all public-sector ICT procurement, effective immediately per the Chief Secretary's foreword; connectivity across ministries, departments and agencies remains the hurdle to electronic government	NO CHANGE, RECORD IMPROVED
Local authorities filing accounts on time	Not held	Only 26 local authorities submitted their 2024 financial statements on time, on the Auditor-General's finding, while the revenue authority pushes businesses onto its fiscalisation data management system - a capacity gap in the state's own reporting that the revenue drive does not address	BASELINE NOT HELD
Parliamentary artificial-intelligence competency programme	BASELINE NOT HELD	Competency-building under way in assisted qualitative research, literature review and document analysis; staff reported using public tools on personal judgment, with limited monitoring of data flows and no consistent approach to fabricated output	<i>Baseline not held</i>

Payments infrastructure filled in at the edges. Mobile wallet holders gained cash-out at two bank machine estates, ten cash-recycler machines were installed at retail outlets with 78 stated in the pipeline, and one operator's wallet remains unactivated for cash-out ([analysis](#)). Charges were capped and transfer limits raised in February 2026 ([policy account](#)).

Land administration moved from a gazetted instrument to a pilot. Statutory Instrument 76 of 2025 was gazetted on 18 July 2025 with commencement not triggered; by April 2026 sixteen conveyancing firms had been selected for a two-week validation pilot ([pilot account](#)). The two held readings of when the 24-month validation window starts have not been reconciled, and the pilot's outcome is not on record.

The digital identity is the row marked *Stalled*, and the registry beneath it has been under modernisation since about 2023 with no completion date and no coverage figure at either end of the window ([ministerial account](#)).

Digitalisation

Digitalisation of sub-national government

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-25	MOVEMENT
Local authority electronic services and revenue systems	Most councils lagging in technology on the Auditor-General's FY2024 audits, with business processes still manual or partially automated, accounting-system modules left unactivated, and most authorities without an enterprise resource planning system for revenue collection and so recognising revenue on a cash basis for want of complete databases; revenue-collection and debt-recovery findings rose from 81 across 51 local authorities to 92 across 60 (2025-06)	Kwekwe City Council bills rates, refuse, sewerage, water and other service charges centrally through the Promun (ERP) package, with each property assigned a unique account number and tariff code; the finance department names "Information Technology and E-Governance" among its five key functions, covering database administration, network security and system workflow; legal basis is the Urban Councils Act s.219 for rates and the Water Act [Chapter 20:22] and Environmental Management Act [Chapter 20:17] for service charges; no user count, collection rate or digital-channel adoption figure published	NO CHANGE, ONE COUNCIL DOCUMENTED AGAINST AN UNCHANGED NATIONAL PICTURE
Satellite kits for local authorities	250 kits handed over 2025-07-24, deployment and maintenance left to councils	No deployment, activation or outcome figure held	NO CHANGE

Rural digital data capture

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-25	MOVEMENT
Rural network population coverage	BASELINE NOT HELD	5G reaches 0.0% of the rural population against 18.9% nationally; 3G reaches 73.7%; 4,681 of 13,104 base stations are rural	<i>Baseline not held</i>
School connectivity and solar programme	Not held	11,500 satellite terminals distributed to schools - 8,000 to those with no wireless network and a further 3,500 to those already connected - with more than 1,300 institutions still to reach and a stated target of internet connectivity, solar power and national-grid access at every school by December 2026; cabinet has separately committed 3% of GDP to research and innovation under the education framework	BASELINE NOT HELD

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-25	MOVEMENT
Universal services fund subscription support	BASELINE NOT HELD	One year of subscription support for digital centres and schools, with extension to rural health centres said to be under consideration; no fund size or disbursement figure held	<i>Baseline not held</i>

Technology

AI

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-25	MOVEMENT
Artificial-intelligence literacy campaign	Did not exist	Named in the strategy as the "Nzwisiso.ai" campaign; a media rights organisation reports that local-language terminology is absent, bounding its reach	ADVANCED
Indigenous-language corpora programme	Did not exist	Committed for Shona, Ndebele and other indigenous languages; the ring-fenced share is unstated	ADVANCED
National artificial-intelligence compute siting	None published	The operator states the infrastructure behind its artificial-intelligence cloud is hosted at an affiliated group's facility in South Africa; no Zimbabwean compute location, capacity or date is stated	ADVANCED
National artificial-intelligence innovation fund	Did not exist	Announced as offering patient capital through blended public and private investment, with banks, pension funds, development finance institutions and mobile operators invited; no size, committed capital, governance or date stated	ADVANCED
National truth-verification platform	Did not exist	Proposed; a media rights organisation reports no supervising institution, criteria or safeguards named	ADVANCED
Harare traffic management system	Reported in operation, described as home-grown	Reported in operation, described as home-grown; the vendor attribution is unreconciled against a research mapping of Chinese-supplied systems	NO CHANGE
Artificial-intelligence remote monitoring and digital twin	BASELINE NOT HELD	Described by the company as advancing, that is, not in production	<i>Baseline not held</i>
Electronic Traffic Management System (Harare City Council)	BASELINE NOT HELD	AI traffic cameras being installed across Harare's CBD ahead of enforcement, with the council calling for advance multi-channel motorist notification before gazetting and a non-penal trial phase; not yet gazetted and no penalty schedule published	<i>Baseline not held</i>
Smart Traffic Management System (ZRP Smart Policing Programme)	BASELINE NOT HELD	AI-powered traffic-camera enforcement expanding beyond initial sites toward a nationwide system under the police Smart Policing Programme; no camera count, coverage map, procurement route or data-retention rule published	<i>Baseline not held</i>
University high-performance computer	BASELINE NOT HELD	Operating, but quoted to local developers at tens of thousands of United States dollars for limited access	<i>Baseline not held</i>

ICT Industry

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-25	MOVEMENT
Scheme of reconstruction transferring passive infrastructure	Real estate and passive telecommunications infrastructure held by the parent's wholly owned vehicles	Transferred as a going concern into the separately listed infrastructure company; ownership and control unchanged	ADVANCED
Base stations deployed by the infrastructure company	BASELINE NOT HELD	90 new base stations in the quarter; 17% of revenue reinvested into capital projects, on an undisclosed revenue base	<i>Baseline not held</i>

Innovation ecosystem

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-25	MOVEMENT
Central bank innovation hub	Did not exist	Announced with an open invitation to industry; no location, opening date or governance held	ADVANCED
Central bank regulatory sandbox	BASELINE NOT HELD	Operating; no cohort count, entrant list or graduation record held	Baseline not held

The window opened with no national artificial-intelligence policy and closed with one that has no legal force. It also opened with no commercial artificial-intelligence service and closed with one, launched in April 2026 on compute drawn from an affiliated group whose physical location the reporting outlet could not establish ([launch account](#)).

The government's own systems moved once, in the last week. The whole-of-government resource planning system was launched on 29 July 2026 with no ministry count, deployment schedule or cost stated ([launch account](#)).

One bilateral position closed. Zimbabwe withdrew from health-funding talks with the United States on 24 February 2026, objecting to long-term access to national health data, an attempt to fold in critical minerals, and a bilateral architecture outside the World Health Organization; the embassy put the value at US\$367m over five years, and about 1.2 million people on United States-supported treatment face wind-down ([withdrawal account](#)).

Capacity

Training and skills

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-25	MOVEMENT
Artificial-intelligence grand challenge	Did not exist	Launched 2026-08-04 across agriculture, health, education, financial services, mining and public administration and stated as a recurring programme; POTRAZ reported 738 applications received and 68 projects selected for an August 2026 boot camp in Nyanga, drawn from healthcare, agriculture, public service delivery and financial technology, narrowed to 18 candidates for the next stage; no award or budget published	ADVANCED
Coding in the secondary curriculum	Did not exist	The regulator and the innovation hubs directed to scale literacy and embed coding from secondary level upward; no curriculum, date or budget published	ADVANCED
Youth digital skills programme (donor-funded)	SEK 36,000,000 committed in 2023, disbursement recorded nil	Same; the published record shows nothing disbursed and an end year of 2027	NO CHANGE
Digital skills ambassadors programme	BASELINE NOT HELD	Named as a running digital-inclusion initiative; no participant count, budget or coverage published	Baseline not held
Digital skills programme targeting 1.5 million people	BASELINE NOT HELD	A target of 1.5m people in coding, artificial-intelligence and data skills; no enrolment or completion figure published	Baseline not held
Government cybersecurity youth training programme	BASELINE NOT HELD	More than 3,000 youths trained at 2026-04-07; no figure published since	Baseline not held

Research institutions

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-25	MOVEMENT
National research programme or research and development expenditure figure	Statutory research council operating since 1986 under the Research Act [Chapter 10:22]; no programme document or R&D expenditure figure previously held	Research Council of Zimbabwe reported total revenue of ZWL 6234329177 (2023) and ZWG 40614638 (2024); the Council pursued amendment of the Research Act in 2024 partly to establish a National Research Fund and developed a Concept Note for a National Research Policy; no gross domestic expenditure on R&D or R&D-as-share-of-GDP figure is published in either year	ADVANCED

Inclusion

Access to services

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-25	MOVEMENT
Fixed broadband technology mix	Wireless 41.84% of fixed broadband subscriptions (Q1 2025)	Wireless 54.54% (Q4 2025); fixed cellular 143,323, copper 87,713, active fibre 86,225	ADVANCED
Free public Wi-Fi hotspot programme	Free Wi-Fi at post offices and community halls under the presidential internet scheme, no count published (2025-07)	409 hotspots deploying in schools, clinics and public spaces against a stated target of 1,000 by end-2026; no completion count published since	ADVANCED
Internet and data traffic	Mobile data traffic 160.33 PB in Q4 2025, up 11.27% on the quarter	Internet and data traffic up 57.28% in Q1 2026	ADVANCED
National financial inclusion strategy	Did not exist	Targets overall usage of formal financial services rising from 70% to 90% by 2026 (digital financial services 77% to 90%, savings 15% to 50%, credit 16% to 50%, insurance 22% to 40%), access from 83% to 95%, and exclusion from 12% to 5%; four pillars – financial innovation, consumer protection and financial capability, microfinancing/MSME/ entrepreneurship development, and devolution – steered by a National Financial Inclusion Steering Committee with its secretariat inside the Reserve Bank; no costed action plan or funding envelope stated	ADVANCED
Presidential internet scheme	Operating; satellite installations and free Wi-Fi at post offices and community halls, no count (2025-07)	Named by the information minister as improving access in previously underserved areas; no site, hotspot or user count published	NO CHANGE, NO SITE COUNT PUBLISHED
Digital centres programme	BASELINE NOT HELD	Operating, with the universal services fund covering one year of connectivity subscriptions; no count, location list or user figure published	Baseline not held
Internet affordability against income	Not held	Internet penetration at 84.55% on the regulator's fourth-quarter 2025 data, with many households spending more than 10% of income to be online against the United Nations' 2% benchmark, and only 62% of the population having reliable electricity	BASELINE NOT HELD
Satellite connectivity at rural health facilities	BASELINE NOT HELD	More than 400 health facilities hold kits with 300 more planned, none activated pending a subscription-fee negotiation; the ICT minister states the universal services fund covers digital centres and schools only	Baseline not held

Digital divides

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-25	MOVEMENT
Household computer ownership	14.2% of households (2020)	11.2% (2025); urban 21.2% against rural 4.7%	REGRESSED
Household internet access	50.1% of households (2020)	75.5% of households (2025); mobile handset ownership 96.4%, rural 94.5%, urban 99.2%	ADVANCED
Satellite retail service affordability	30,907 subscriptions (Q1 2025); hardware US\$350, the smaller unit US\$200, subscriptions from US\$30 a month, access reported as mostly urban	67,057 subscriptions (Q4 2025); members of parliament reported packages rising from about US\$65 to over US\$100	ADVANCED, IN SCALE ONLY; AFFORDABILITY UNCHANGED

The two household measures moved in opposite directions between the 2020 and 2025 surveys: internet access up from 50.1% to 75.5% of households, computer ownership down from 14.2% to 11.2% ([survey account](#)). Access has moved onto handsets, and the [urban and rural computer figures of 21.2% and 4.7%](#) are where the gap now sits.

Free public wireless hotspots went from an unnumbered installation programme to 409 deploying against a stated target of 1,000 by end-2026, with no completion count published since April ([hotspot account](#)). Satellite kits for rural health facilities went from nothing on record to more than 400 delivered and none activated ([National Assembly account](#)).

Data

National statistics

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-25	MOVEMENT
ICT access by households and use by individuals survey	The 2020 round the most recent on record	The 2025 round published, covering all ten provinces	ADVANCED
Regulator's abridged sector performance report	A quarterly series published; the Q4 2025 edition then reachable only through partial extraction	The Q4 2025 edition held in full: internet penetration 84.55%, mobile penetration 107.04%, 366 5G base stations reaching 18.9% of population and 0.0% of rural areas	NO CHANGE
2026/27 Household Budget Survey	BASELINE NOT HELD	Household listing under way across all ten provinces to update the sampling frame, recording residential and non-residential structures, occupancy status, household counts per structure and heads of household; no fieldwork date or publication date for the survey itself	Baseline not held

Open data

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-25	MOVEMENT
National artificial-intelligence and data platform	Did not exist	Provided for to supply countrywide datasets, infrastructure and compute, and named in the strategy as Project "Pangolin"; a media rights organisation reported it consolidates fragmented government databases without stated safeguards	ADVANCED
Open government data initiative under the strategy	Did not exist	Announced as a commons for public institutions, industry and researchers to share anonymised datasets, with selected government datasets stated to become publicly accessible within six months of 2026-08-04; no governing rule, dataset list or portal held	ADVANCED

Use of satellite data

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-25	MOVEMENT
National geospatial and earth-observation data programme	A national geospatial and space agency established in 2019; no dataset catalogue held	The Zimbabwe National Geospatial and Space Agency, established under section 24 of the Research Act by general notice rather than by dedicated statute, and under the science ministry rather than the ICT ministry; no programme document, dataset catalogue or budget held	NO CHANGE

Geopolitics

US / hyperscaler activities

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-25	MOVEMENT
Bilateral health cooperation memorandum	Under negotiation; the draft called clearly unbalanced in a December 2025 presidential memo	Talks ended over long-term United States access to national health data, an attempt to fold in critical minerals, and a bilateral architecture outside the World Health Organization; the United States embassy stated in August 2026 that the conditions were co-investment, financial accountability and the sharing of disease specimens during outbreaks, and that assertions it sought Zimbabweans' personal data are categorically false; about 1.2m people on United States-supported HIV treatment face wind-down. The two accounts were reconciled on 2026-08-09 against the strategy's own model texts, both acquired that day. The model Data Sharing Agreement gives the United States secure, uninterrupted access, expressly including login credentials, to seven national health systems including electronic medical records, for twenty-five years continuing ten years past termination — and in the same clause tells the partner that to the maximum extent practical it should not provide individual level data or personally identifiable information unless there is no other way, the model access role being a viewer role without access to such information. The template memorandum's section 2.1.2 requires physical specimens and related data, including genetic sequence data, of detected pathogens with epidemic potential to be provided within five days of detection for twenty-five years. Both public accounts are therefore supportable on the templates: Harare is describing standing credentialled access to live national systems and specimen transfer, Washington is denying the transfer of identifiable records. Neither template is the Zimbabwe draft, which was never signed and does not exist as a public document	CLOSED
Cloud partner experience centre	Did not exist	Africa's first such centre, operated by a Zimbabwean-owned group, giving on-continent access to a United States vendor's cloud and artificial-intelligence tools	ADVANCED
Satellite subscriptions as a share of the African market	Not held for 2025-08	67,057 subscribers at Q4 2025, up 31.62% quarter on quarter, the operator's fastest-growing African market	ADVANCED
Satellite operator's licence award date and terms	Licensed since September 2024; award date and terms not held	Licensed 2024-09-06 on a telecommunication licence for network services and a national internet service provider licence, with service beginning the same day and the regulator announcing it on 2024-09-10	NO CHANGE
Terrestrial segment of a trans-continental cable	Announced 2024, with a terrestrial route through six countries including Zimbabwe, ready for service 2027	Unchanged: ready for service still stated as 2027, with no Zimbabwe landing or capacity figure published	NO CHANGE

China activities

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-25	MOVEMENT
Chinese-supplied city surveillance systems	Deployed without adequate legal oversight	Deployed without adequate legal oversight, and documented as repurposed against political opposition	NO CHANGE
National data centre, Harare	Operating since February 2021	Operating; no current capacity, utilisation or tenancy figure held	NO CHANGE

Gulf/UAE activities

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-25	MOVEMENT
Coding programme delivered with the United Arab Emirates	BASELINE NOT HELD	Running against a target of 1.5 million people; no enrolment figure, budget, agreement date or completion target held	Baseline not held

Where the record is thin

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	WHAT WOULD SETTLE IT	LAST PROBED
Digital skills partnership agreement with the United Arab Emirates	The signed memorandum or programme document behind the 1.5 million coding programme; the base carries one excerpt source naming the partner and one later restatement of the target that does not, with no signing date, value, delivery partner or enrolment figure	2026-08-06
The 2025 household survey report	The statistics agency and regulator publication itself; the base holds only one outlet's account, so the sample design, provincial breakdowns and the rural and urban series behind the headline figures are that outlet's selection	2026-08-06
Government interoperability framework	A published interoperability framework or data-exchange specification; the base holds the technology unit naming connectivity across ministries as the hurdle and a ministerial commitment to open interface standards, and no framework document	2026-08-06
National electronic services portal	The address and service inventory of a citizen-facing government services portal; the base holds two sector portals and nothing that aggregates services	2026-08-06
National digital identity enrolment statistics	Any registrar-general or home affairs figure for cards issued or persons enrolled; the base establishes the announcement and the non-start, and holds no enrolment number at any date	2026-08-06
ICT Policy 2026-2030	The policy document, or a gazette notice or ministry release announcing it; the base carries only the statistics agency's director-general naming it on 2026-07-20 as a framework the household survey will inform	2026-08-06
National digital literacy programme or measured literacy rate	A statistics agency or regulator digital-skills module, or a named national literacy programme document; the base carries one source on this subject, a continental review, and literacy appears only as a barrier named by the central bank and as a service offered at digital centres	2026-08-06
Regulator's Q1 2026 sector performance report	The regulator's own quarterly report; the base holds the Q4 2025 report in full but carries Q1 2026 only through a news account of a post-Cabinet briefing, so the 379 base stations, the 19,000 km backbone and the 57.28% traffic rise are all secondary and no per-operator table exists to check them against	2026-08-06
National Cybersecurity Strategy document	The strategy itself; the base holds a one-minute report of the October 2025 launch and nothing else — no objectives, institutional arrangements, timetable or budget, and no subsequent milestone	2026-08-06

Twenty-eight rows are *Not held* at both ends, and all 28 were searched on 6 August. Twenty-five name published documents and three are searched absences — among them the local-ownership rule for telecommunications operators, which the base could see only as a headline in captured page furniture and which the probe establishes was made and then repealed within weeks.

Three of them tightened during the window. The regulator's first-quarter 2026 report is absent, so the fibre and base-station figures this report carries for that quarter come from a ministerial briefing rather than from the series that would corroborate them. The universal services fund's accounts are absent, at the point where the fund is being

committed to a tower relocation programme, a year of school and digital-centre connectivity, and an unquantified artificial-intelligence share. And the satellite operator's licence terms are absent, while [its subscriptions grew 67% across the window](#) and a continental study set African licence fees against what states charge for mobile spectrum.

The oldest absence is the plainest: no national incident response team appears anywhere in Zimbabwe's base, and the monitoring centre established under the 2021 Act sits in the Office of the President and is a different kind of body. The probe of 6 August establishes that this is an intake gap rather than a real one — a national team was built with the International Telecommunication Union under a numbered project and its acting manager speaks about it on the record.

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This is a dated edition and is not revised after publication. If a figure here has moved, the current edition will say so.